

Gradient Descent Intuition

repeat until convergence {

$$w = w - \alpha \frac{d}{dw} (J(w, b)) \quad \leftarrow \text{derivative}$$

learning rate

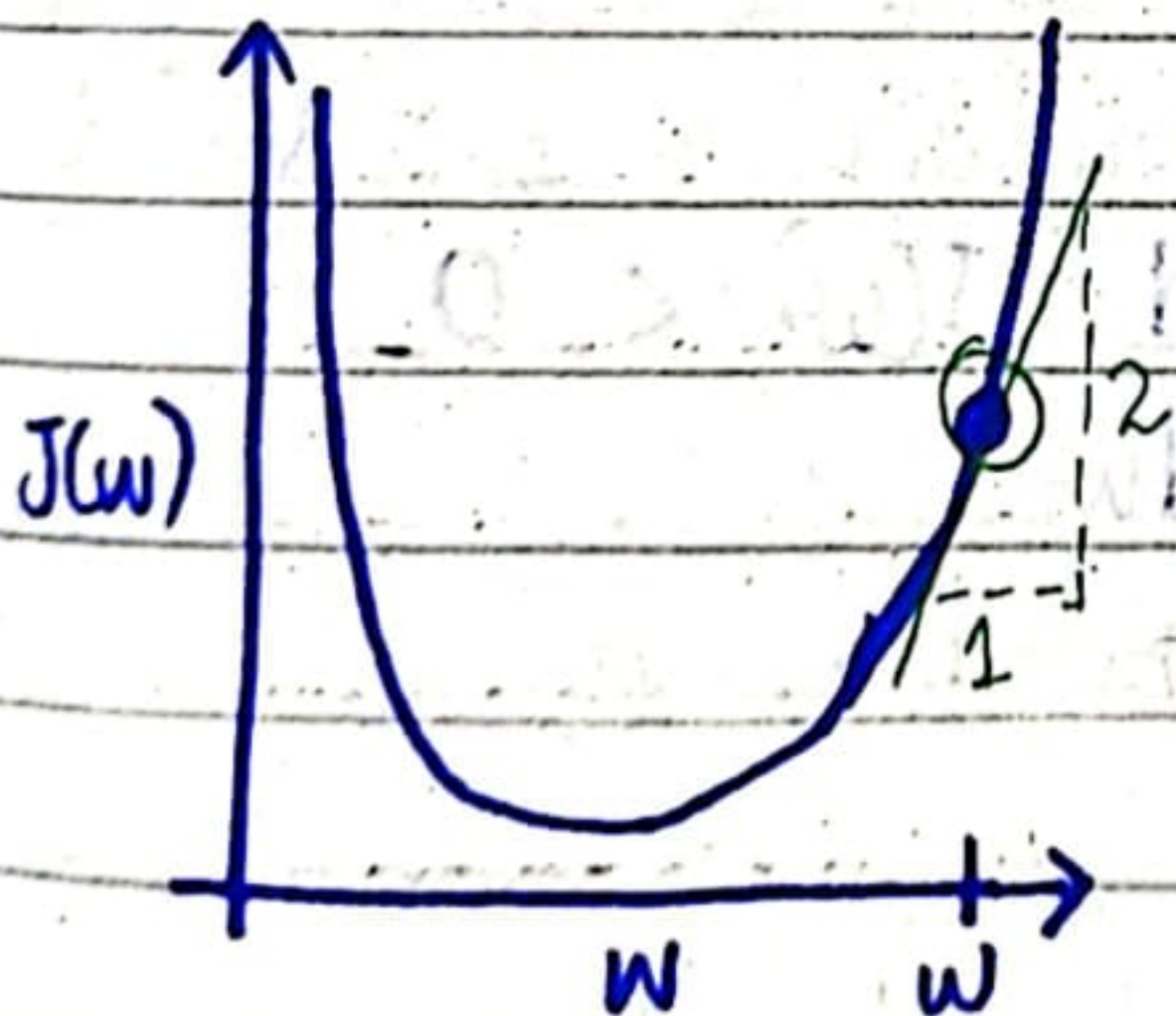
$$b = b - \alpha \frac{d}{db} J(w, b).$$

we'll use slightly simpler example: (minimizing)
with only one parameter to see the algo:

- $J(w)$

- $w = w - \alpha \frac{d}{dw} J(w)$

- $\min_w J(w)$



A way to think a derivative at this point is to draw a tangent line.

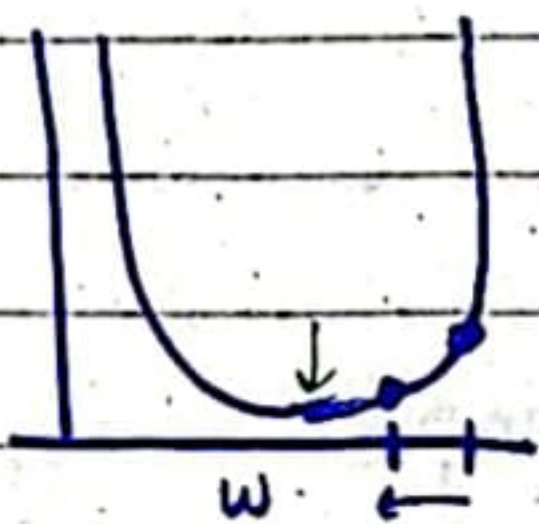
The slope of this line is derivative of func J at this point. To get slope you can make the triangle and divide height/width

& when tangent line is pointing to up & the right, slope is positive.

• so the derivative $\frac{dJ(w)}{dw} > 0$.

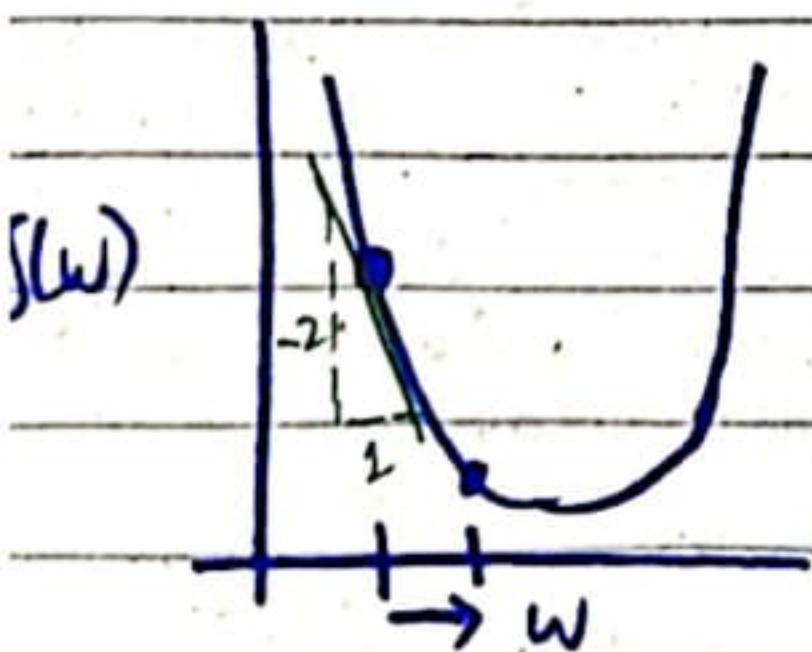
• so $w = w - \alpha \cdot \text{positive number}$
 $\rightarrow$ always +ve

• now $w = w - \alpha \cdot p \cdot n$
 $\rightarrow$ w will update to smaller number.



So on graph, when we decrease w, it's right for our goal as $J(w)$ also decrease as seen.

Another example:
diff starting point;



Now slope is negative
as down & to the right.
So derivative at this point

$$\frac{dJ(w)}{dw} < 0$$

• $w = w - \alpha \cdot \text{negative no.}$

so w increases

as $- \& -$ gives $+$.